

Mission and Vision Statements

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Mission Statements

- The mission statement is a succinct description of the basic purposes of the organization
- This outlines the reason why an organization exists and the work it will carry out
- The mission statement serves two purposes:
 - The mission guides decision-making for the organization
 - The mission provides a useful, short description for all individuals involved with the organization

Characteristics of Good Mission Statements

- Good mission statements have two key components
 - ① A purpose statement – what the organization seeks to accomplish
 - Consists of two parts:
 - A phrase indicating a change in status
 - The problem / condition that will be changed
 - ② A business statement – the main method for fulfilling the purpose
 - This serves as the connecting vehicle to what tangible action will be taken to accomplish the purpose statement
- Mission statements should be memorable and “catchy”
- As mission statements guide decision-making, they can also neither be too narrow or too broad
- Good mission statements provide:
 - Organizational stability
 - Organizational constraint
 - Without adhering to the mission, or a poor mission to adhere to, organizations can operate aimlessly though “mission drift”
 - Public relations

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Vision Statements

- The vision statement conveys the ideal future of an organization
- This details what organizational success will look like and how organizational success will impact the community
- A vision statement can detail:
 - The organization's place in society
 - Intended growth
 - Incorporation of new technologies
 - Establish its reputation
 - Impact public perception
 - How an organization will solve problems
- Successful vision statements convey two components:
 - 1 An organization's core ideology
 - 2 A "moonshot" goal with a vivid description of the future

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Group Discussion Question

- Look up the mission and vision statement of your favorite Does the mission statement serve the two main purposes outlined in Chapter 6? Does the vision statement serve its purpose outlined in Chapter 6? Why or why not? How could each statement be improved?